

a little more about the industry and waking up to the builder's lies, we could
!have done a lot better

Five shocking truths about HMOs

I didn't like the house very much, but my mentor had asked me to fill it with professional tenants. This was a great practice run for when I had my own. I was going to take this seriously and learn all I could. In my mind,
!this was my property right now

By the time I had rented out this 5-bed HMO I had learned some million-dollar lessons. I was using a website called sparerroom.co.uk and every day I would phone prospective housemates, show people around the property and get their feedback, as well as constantly check the competition in the area to
.see what the rental fee was for other HMOs

.I noticed something very strange

Finding tenants is easy (1

I had assumed that it would take a month or two to find a tenant, and then they would need another month or two to move in. Filling a whole house
!would surely take three to six months? I was wrong

.I filled the whole house within six to eight weeks

Every single day new prospective housemates would be posting on sparerroom.co.uk asking for rooms. I would call them and they would want to view and move in almost immediately. I charged an admin fee to the tenant of £90 and that was my only commission. The landlord was getting a
.free tenant finder – me – and I was learning loads

The tenants were never local, but were relocating for work reasons from all over the country and all over Europe. They were young professionals wanting to focus on their career for a few years, while saving as much money as possible for later in life. They had a choice: they could rent a small apartment for about £500, plus pay their bills of around £200 which